

Top 5 Back-to-School Must-Have Items

By: Chaz Wilke - Staff Writer



As the school year ramps back into session for children of all ages across this fine nation, we the stewards of the next generation breathe a collective sigh of relief. Summers can be a blast, but there's nothing like the peace and quiet that accompanies a school bus fading into the distance on a crisp autumn morn.

We love our kids but sometimes a little break is nice. Of course, that doesn't mean the kids don't get anything out of the deal.

Each year dozens of companies create the latest back-to-school shopping lists. Surely you all remember trapper keepers (surprise: they're back!) and the fresh paper smell of a new notebook. We've compiled a list of the top 5 back-to-school must-have items for your kids this fall. These items should make your tykes as excited to return to school as you are about them getting out of the house for those few precious hours a day.

An advertisement for Solar Me Home. At the top, it says "Electricity bill too high?" in white text on a blue background. Below that, "GO SOLAR" is written in large, bold, yellow letters. Underneath, "Find Installers!" is written in a script font with a curved arrow pointing to the left. A white rounded rectangle contains the text "Your Zip Code" and a green circular button with the word "GO" in white. At the bottom, there is a photo of a smiling family (a man, a woman, and two children) in front of a house with solar panels on the roof. The Solar Me Home logo is in the top right corner.

(<https://solarmehome.com/?cid=28806>)

An advertisement for Pursue Mortgage. The background is a dark teal color with a silhouette of a tree on the left and a house on the right. In the center, there is a silhouette of a family (a man, a woman, and a child) walking. The text "pursuemortgage" is written in white, with "pursue" in a smaller font and "mortgage" in a larger font. Below that, "Thinking About Refinancing?" is written in white. At the bottom, there is a yellow button with the text "Find Lenders Now" in black.

(<https://pursuemortgage.com/?cid=28806>)



Backpacks

This is the frontline of cool for a child of any age. What is strapped to their back will broadcast their status to everyone they pass in the halls. While you want to make sure the backpack covers your child's needs, you've got a world of options to choose from therein. Many youngsters have to carry more books than ever. To avoid [back problems](http://bit.ly/1LgUqmK) (<http://bit.ly/1LgUqmK>), many have turned to backpacks that look similar to carryon luggage. Of course, not much compares to the classic styling of JanSport's [Superbreak](http://bit.ly/1Jcct6Y) (<http://bit.ly/1Jcct6Y>) backpack!

Highlighters

Chisel-tipped highlighters are so last gen. These days, kids are treated with a [multi-tipped highlighter](http://bit.ly/1NdSbAX) (<http://bit.ly/1NdSbAX>), perfect for underlining, highlighting and general studying preparedness!

Headphones

If you're part of the lucky few who live close enough for your child to walk to school, there's a good chance they will want a pair of headphones to wrap them in aural bliss as they saunter to school. Plus, large over-ear headphones can double as trendy ear muffs in the winter months!

The depth of options available to you with headphones can be a bit off putting. But there is a new company looking to give a charitable edge for those wanting a little musical accompaniment on the walk to school. [Lstn](http://bit.ly/1fkTGP3) (<http://bit.ly/1fkTGP3>) creates beautiful wood adorned headphones and is committed to donating a portion of the [proceeds](http://bit.ly/1DYfz2t) (<http://bit.ly/1DYfz2t>) to help others get hearing aids.

Trapper Keepers

These great school staples from the '70s are [back](http://bit.ly/1IYEcj5) (<http://bit.ly/1IYEcj5>) and better than ever! Trapper Keeper decided to reintroduce the original plastic and Velcro collegiate catchall and update the line with new luxury high-quality versions as well! Now everyone from preschool to graduation day can find a trapper keeper that matches their needs.

Designer Spiral Notebooks

Help your kid keep her cool during class by taking notes in one of these [fashionable](http://bit.ly/1JmzLOj) (<http://bit.ly/1JmzLOj>) spiral notebooks from designer Kate Spade! Surely the envy of all fashion-forward youths, these notebooks are available in both black stripes and gold polka dots. The price tag might sting a little, at \$14 a pop you might just have the leverage to barter for higher grades from your back-to-school bound youngster!

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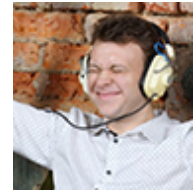
Takeaway

Preparing your child with the right back-to-school gear can be fun for the whole family! It can be tough to predict just what might be popular each year, but hopefully this list helped point you and your family in the right direction. Happy hunting!



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Few things are permanent in this disposable culture of ours. But it's still hard to believe how quickly to-



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There is no more potent image of American prosperity than a sprawling tree-lined street filled with large single-family homes. In a word: suburbia. Here,

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